



Final Project: Develop a Process Map and Narrative

Time estimate: 7 minutes

Welcome to the final project segment of this course. In this module, you will apply the concepts covered in process mapping and process narratives. You will receive a use case describing a real-world service scenario, and your task is to interpret it, map it visually, document it formally, and reflect on the process.

Introduction

This final project requires you to apply the core skills learned in this course, specifically process mapping, process narrative development, and reflective evaluation. Using the provided use case, you will create a detailed process map that visually represents the workflow, develop a structured narrative that explains each step with clarity and accuracy, and write a thoughtful reflection that describes what you learned, the challenges you faced, and how process documentation can be validated and improved in real organizational settings.

The project is designed to strengthen your ability to translate operational scenarios into clear, complete, and professional process documentation. By completing this final project, you will be able to:

- Analyze a real-world operational scenario and translate it into a detailed process map that includes actors, flows, decisions, and alternative paths.
- Construct a structured, professional process narrative that clearly explains each step of the workflow, encompassing triggers, inputs, outputs, actors, decisions, and exceptions.
- Evaluate and reflect on your own process documentation, identifying strengths, challenges, and opportunities for improvement in both mapping and narrative-building activities.

Use case: Request defective part replacement

Scenario

The scenario describes a customer who returns to an auto parts store because a recently purchased part is defective. The store must verify the purchase, inspect the part, check inventory, and decide whether to issue a replacement, refund, credit, or deny the request. Your task is to document this entire process clearly through a process map and a process narrative.

Actor: Customer (Auto Parts Buyer)

Goal: Replace a defective auto part recently purchased.

Preconditions

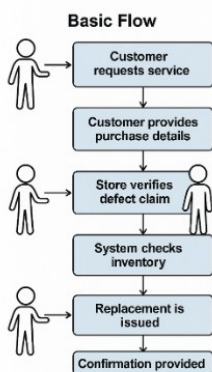
- Customer provides proof of purchase (receipt or order number).
- Part is within the return/replacement policy window.
- Replacement part is available in the inventory.

Submission guidelines

- Ensure a good internet connection to create and submit this assignment.
- Use any word-processing or spreadsheet tool to create the tables for the assignment.
- Utilize the templates below for submission. To download the templates below, right-click the link and select "Save link as":
 - [Download the .pdf template](#)
 - [Download the .docx template](#)
- Submit the final project as a filled .pdf file to enable accurate evaluation.

Basic flow

- 1. Customer requests service**
The customer contacts the auto parts store—either in person, by phone, or through an online portal—and reports that the part is defective.
- 2. Customer provides purchase details**
The customer supplies their order number or receipt, enabling the store system or clerk to validate the purchase.
- 3. Store verifies defect claim**
The clerk inspects the physical part or reviews digital evidence (e.g., photos or a description if the request is online).
- 4. System checks inventory**
The system confirms whether an identical or equivalent replacement part is currently in stock.
- 5. Replacement is issued**
If the replacement item is available, the clerk initiates the replacement transaction and provides the new part to the customer.
- 6. Confirmation provided**
The system generates a replacement confirmation, such as a printed receipt or automatic email.



Alternative flows

A1: No inventory available

If no replacement is currently in stock, the system presents alternative options:

- Refund
- Store credit
- Back-order (if applicable)

A2: Purchase cannot be verified

If the customer cannot present proof of purchase:

- The replacement request is denied.
- The customer is informed of acceptable documentation requirements.

A3: Part shows signs of misuse

If inspection reveals misuse or damage not caused by a manufacturing defect:

- The request is rejected.

- The customer is reminded of applicable policy limitations.

Step-by-step project instructions

1. Review the use case

Study the full basic flow and alternative flows. Understand all key actors, steps, decisions, and potential outcomes.

2. Map the process

Use a diagramming tool of your choice (e.g., Lucidchart, Draw.io, Visio).
Include:

- Swimlanes for actors
- Decision diamonds
- Clear labeling of alternative flows
- Start and end points
- Populate the template provided

Export as **Task1_ProcessMap.pdf**.

3. Create the process narrative

Use the provided Excel template and populate each column:

- Step ID
- Description
- Actor
- Trigger
- Inputs
- Outputs
- Notes/alternative paths

Ensure the narrative aligns exactly with **your** process map.
Export as **Task2_ProcessNarrative.pdf** or **.xlsx**.

4. Write your reflection

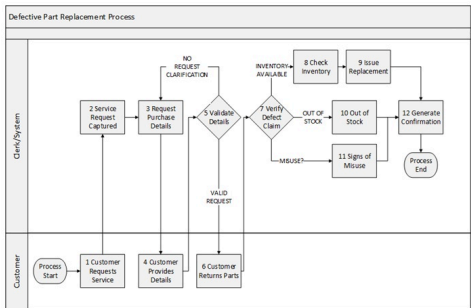
Respond to all prompts with clear, thoughtful explanations supported by examples.
Export as **Task3_Reflection.pdf** or **.docx**.

Grading

This final project is worth a total of **10 points** and includes three tasks. Each task evaluates your ability to interpret a scenario, create a visual workflow, and reflect on your learning.

Task 1: Process map (4 points)

You will create a complete process map that represents the basic flow and alternative flows of the defective part replacement scenario. Your map should clearly identify the actors involved, the decisions that must be made, and the sequence of steps in the process. It should follow standard process mapping conventions and present the workflow in a clear and organized way. You may use the flowchart below to help you create the process map.



Task 2: Process narrative (4 points)

You will develop a structured process narrative that provides a detailed explanation of each step in the workflow. The narrative must align with your process map and include key elements such as the actor responsible for each step, the trigger for the action, the required inputs, the resulting outputs, and a clear description of the activity.

Task 3: Reflection (2 points)

You will write a reflection that summarizes what you learned about process mapping and documentation. Your reflection should describe the challenges you encountered while building your map and narrative and explain how managers or analysts can validate and improve documented processes in real work environments.

High-scoring submissions:

- Demonstrate accurate interpretation of the use case
- Show deliberate structure
- Communicate clearly
- Present alignment between narrative and visual process map

Summary

In this final project, you will learn to analyze a real-world defective part replacement process, create a detailed process map with actors, flows, decisions, and alternative paths, and construct a professional process narrative that clearly describes each step, including triggers, inputs, outputs, and exceptions. You will also evaluate your documentation, reflect on strengths and areas for improvement, and submit a complete Word or PDF file demonstrating your process mapping and narrative skills. This project will help you apply business process modeling concepts in a practical, structured way while developing critical analytical and documentation abilities.